This somewhat confusingly named function will transform a string that contains regex meta-characters with backslash escapes (not quotes). It accepts two arguments: the sample string and an optional string that defines a delimiter character:

```
print preg_quote("/(\d+)-[^a-Z].*/");
print PHP_EOL;
print preg_quote("/(\d+)-[^a-Z].*/", '/');
```

```
Output:
/\(\\d\+\)\-\[\^a\-Z\]\.\*/
\/\(\\d\+\)\-\[\^a\-Z\]\.\*\/
```

Note that delimiters are only escaped if the delimiter character is specified.

preg_filter()

This function accepts a pattern or an array of patterns, a replacement string or array of strings, and a sample string (or array thereof). There is also an optional parameter for setting limits on the number of replacements performed and a by-reference parameter for reporting on the number of replacements.

```
$text = 'I like bananas, oranges, and apples.';
print preg_filter('/(bananas|oranges|apples)/', 'fruit', $text);
```

```
Output:
I like fruit, fruit, and fruit.
```

Pretty straightforward stuff, and for simple replacements like above, it is advisable to use `str_replace()`, which will be faster. Things get more interesting (and useful) when you make use of back-references and arrays:

```
$text = 'The tortoise overtook the hare.';
$patterns = [
    '/(tortoise)/',
    '/(hare)/'
];
$replacements = [
    'slow ${1}',
    'quick ${1}',
];
```